

Trills

A trill calls for a rapid alternation between the main melody note and the note immediately above it in the scale of the piece. It can be notated with either the *tr* marking, the wavy line, or both. Often the trill concludes with a turn, or a quick use of the note below the main melody note.



△ Writing trills

Composers or arrangers may notate a wavy line to indicate that the trill continues for the entire note value.



The main note is D,
the trill note is E.

71 △ Playing trills

This is a written approximation of how the trill might sound; the two notes are played rapidly and smoothly in alternation.



Turn begins here

72 △ Trill ending in a turn

Sometimes the end of the turn concluding a trill slows down to emphasize the return of the main melodic note.

Mordents

Mordents are like trills with just one shake, or repetition, of the ornamental note. The first mordent symbol means to play the main note with a single rapid alternation with the note above, or below. The second mordent symbol means to play the note below and then return to the main note.



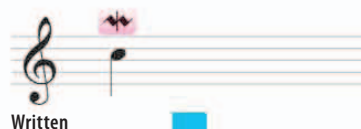
Written



Played

73 △ Melody note and the note above it

A smooth, fast alternation—performed on the beat—between the main note and its upper neighbor.



Written



Played

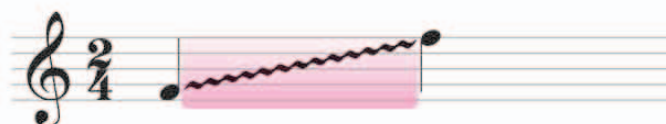
△ Melody note and the note below it

The vertical line through the mordent indicates that the lower neighbor of the main note should be played.

74

Glissando

A trill and a glissando are both denoted with a wavy line, but a glissando is a sweep across all the whole steps between two pitches. Sometimes the performer plays only the notes in the scale that are appropriate for the tonality of the piece.



Written



Played

In C major, the glissando notes are the whole steps of the C major scale, starting on F and ending an octave higher.

75 ▷ Glissando

The speed of the glissando determines whether the listener can distinguish its individual pitches. Blurring together all the pitches between two whole steps is called a portamento.